

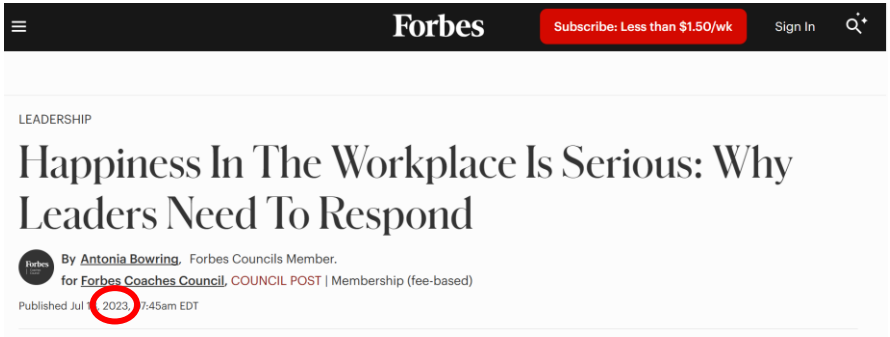
Well-being & Happiness

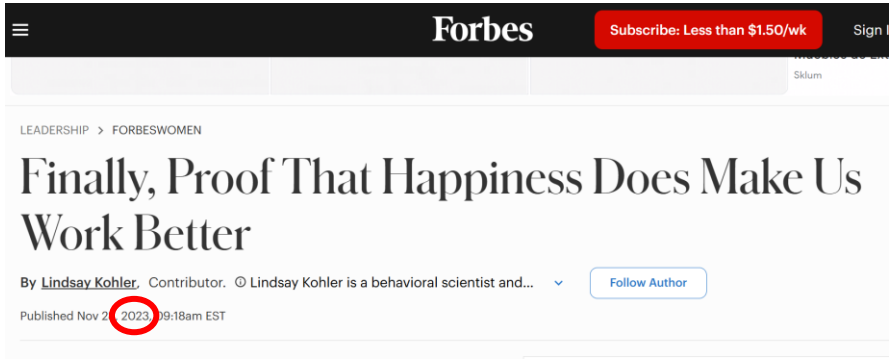
MiM – Class 2026-2027 – Section A

Isabel Villamor

Why Should Leaders Care About Happiness?


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Happy workers are 13% more productive

PUBLISHED
24 OCT 2019

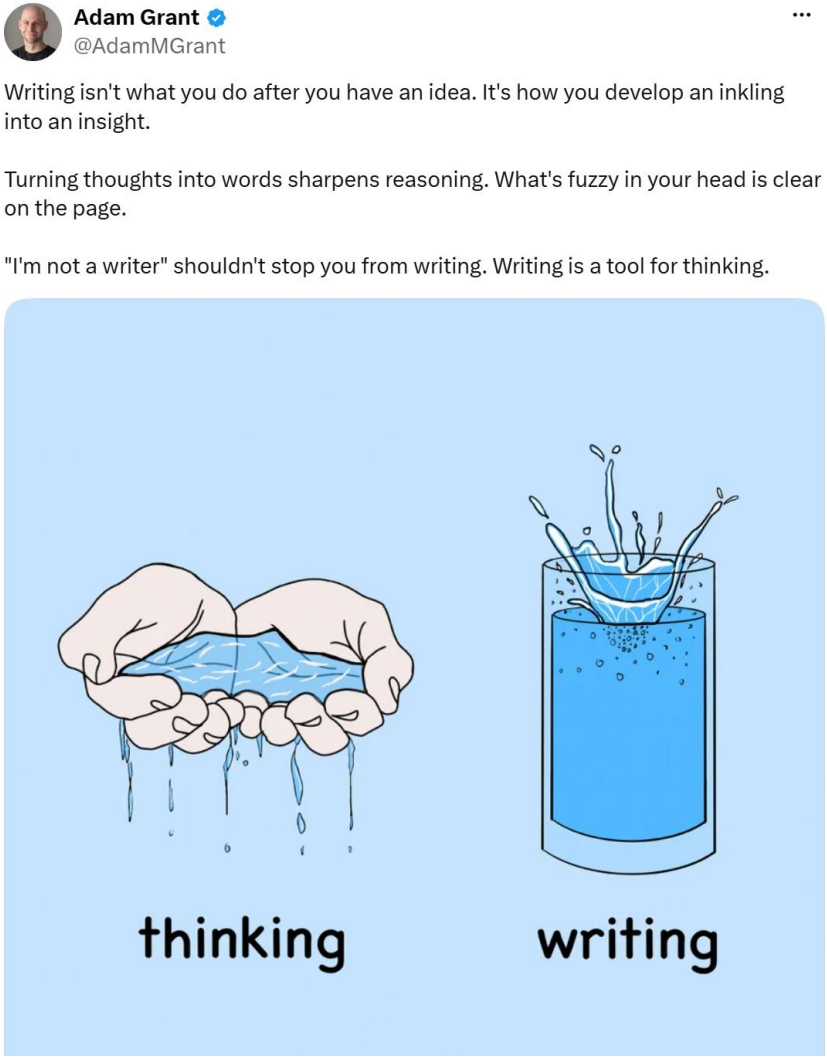
RESEARCH BUSINESS SOCIETY

Research by Oxford University's Saïd Business School, in collaboration with British multinational telecoms firm BT, has found a conclusive link between happiness and

Caring about the well-being of your people at work is the moral thing to do — but it also makes business sense. A recent study published in *Management Science* finds that happiness increases productivity. The effects are large, as well. Each one-unit increase in happiness (on a scale of 0-10) led to a 12% increase in productivity. Productivity was measured by the number of sales employees made.

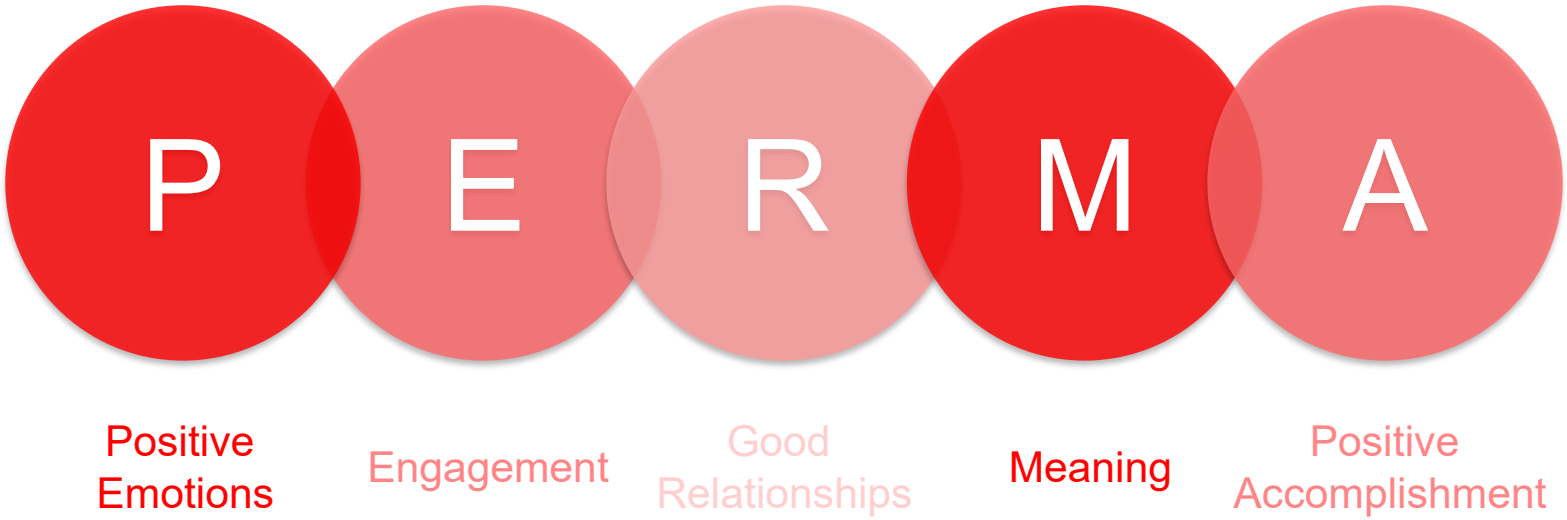
While the connection between happiness and productivity is fairly intuitive, isolating a direct link between the two is more difficult. Part of this challenge is inconsistent definitions of happiness and productivity. But companies also often struggle to measure happiness, and without that piece of information, it's impossible to link the two concepts.

If you're going to invest now in your future best self, where would you put your time & energy?



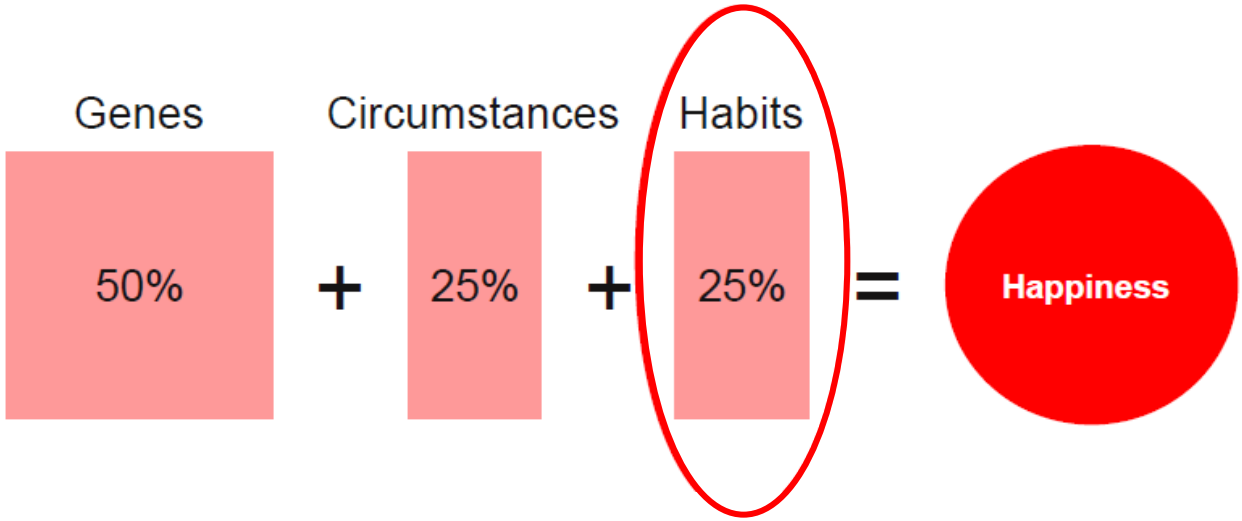
Write down 3 ideas

What is Happiness?



Which PERMA dimensions match your investments?

Why Are Some People Happier Than Others?





Pleasant life

Name a positive emotion other than happiness

Perceptions of Observable Behaviors



Positive Emotions

P E R M A

Why Happiness Is Elusive

- Heritable: 50% is shaped by our genes
- We Adapt Fast: Frequency matters more than intensity
- Dopamine Tricks Us: Novelty feels good, but fades quickly
- Stable Over Time: We bounce back (lottery winners vs. paraplegics)
- Too Many Choices: More options can lead to less satisfaction
- Impact Bias: We overrate future joys (and underrate the costs) (D. Gilbert)

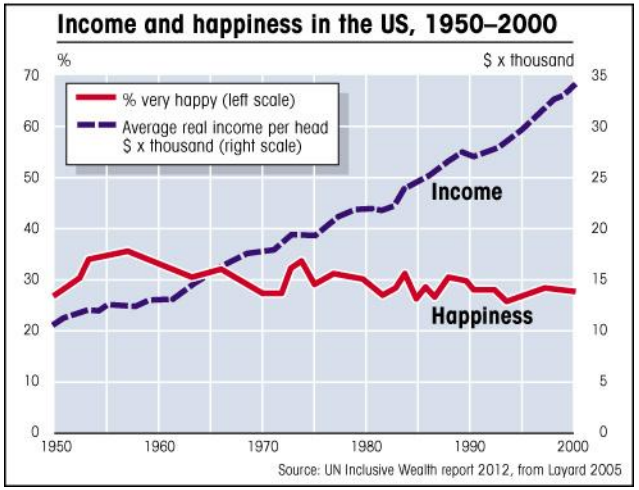


Which happiness trap has fooled you?

What Can YOU Do?

P E R M A

- Rethink Money:
  - More boosts happiness—only up to ~$75K (Kahneman et al., 2006)
  - It can increase selfishness (Vohs et al., 2006)
  - Nicer homes don't improve life satisfaction (Nakazano et al., 2010)
- Spend on experiences, not stuff:
  - Experiential (vs. material) purchases make people happier (Van Boven & Gilovitch, 2003)
  - Even anticipating them feels better (Kumar et al., 2014)
- Buy Back Your Time:
  - Time Famine: We feel time-starved (Perlow, 1999)
  - Outsource tasks you don't enjoy
- Give it away



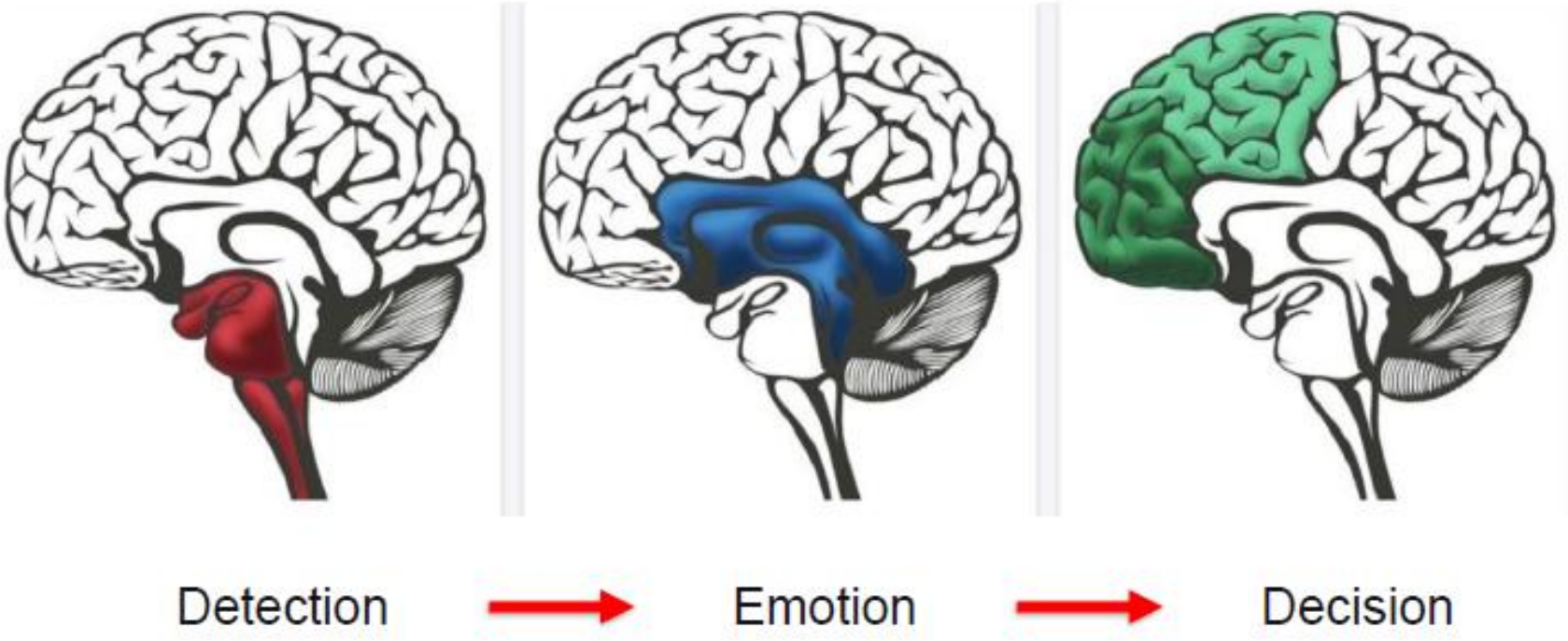
If you had €100 for your well-being, how would you spend it?

Suppressing emotions





Emotional self-management



What is the difference between listening to anger and obeying it?

Emotional Self-management

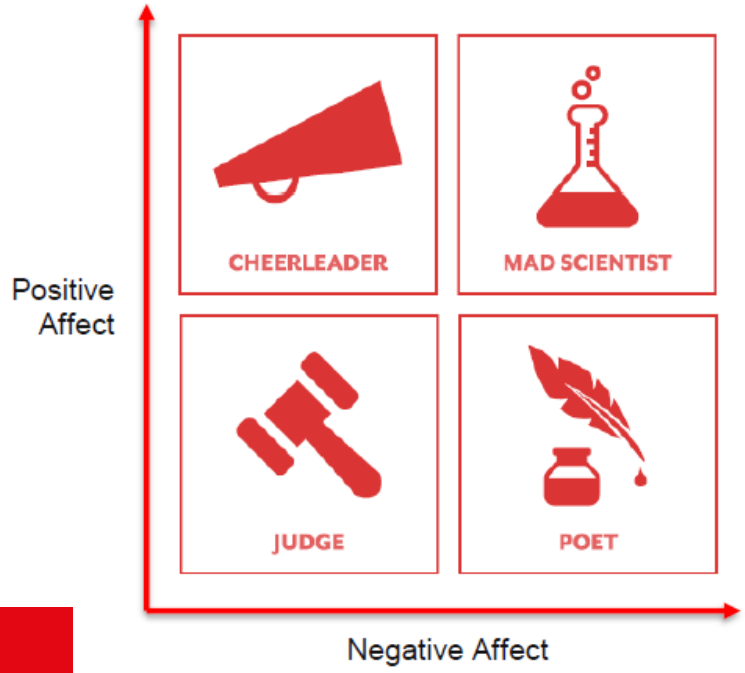
P E R M A

1. Understand the Science: Your emotions are just information

- They are not good or bad
- Don't fight information
- We all have the same emotions, but in different intensities

2. Know yourself: You have a unique emotional profile

- You are not defective
- Know and appreciate yourself
- Manage to your strengths (PANAS)
- Remediate your weaknesses



Predict your emotional profile (scale: 1-5)

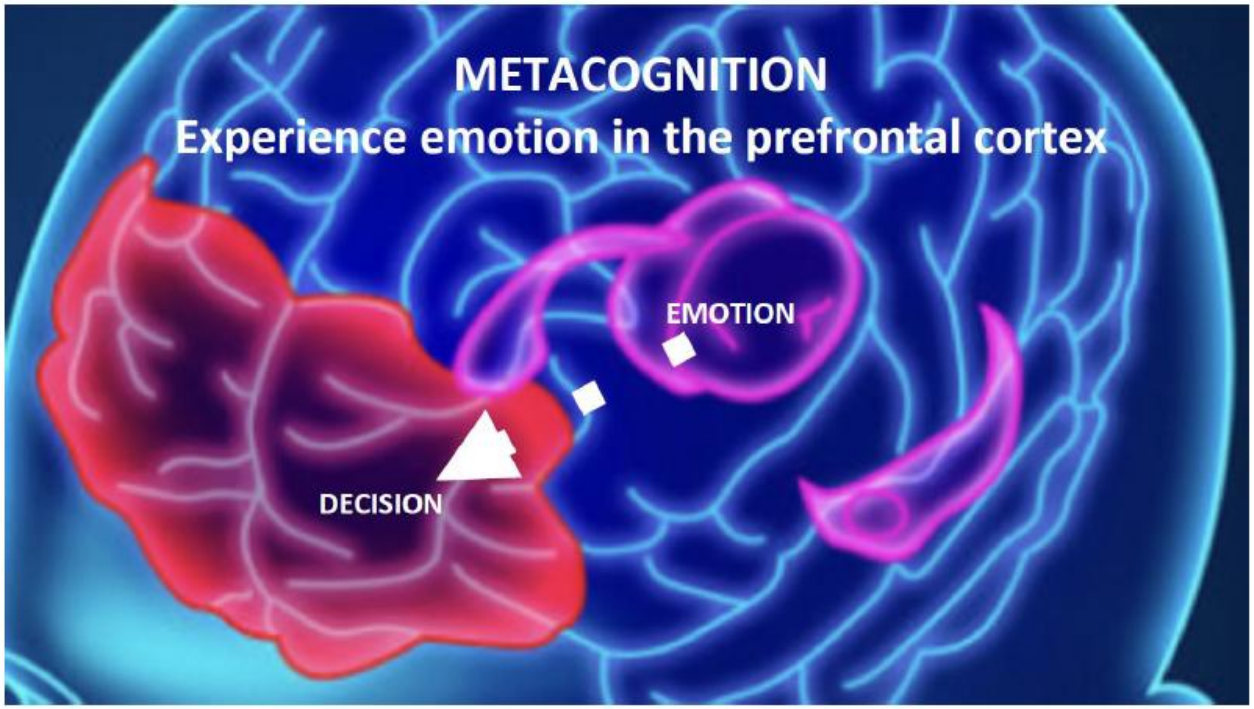
Emotional Self-management

P E R M A

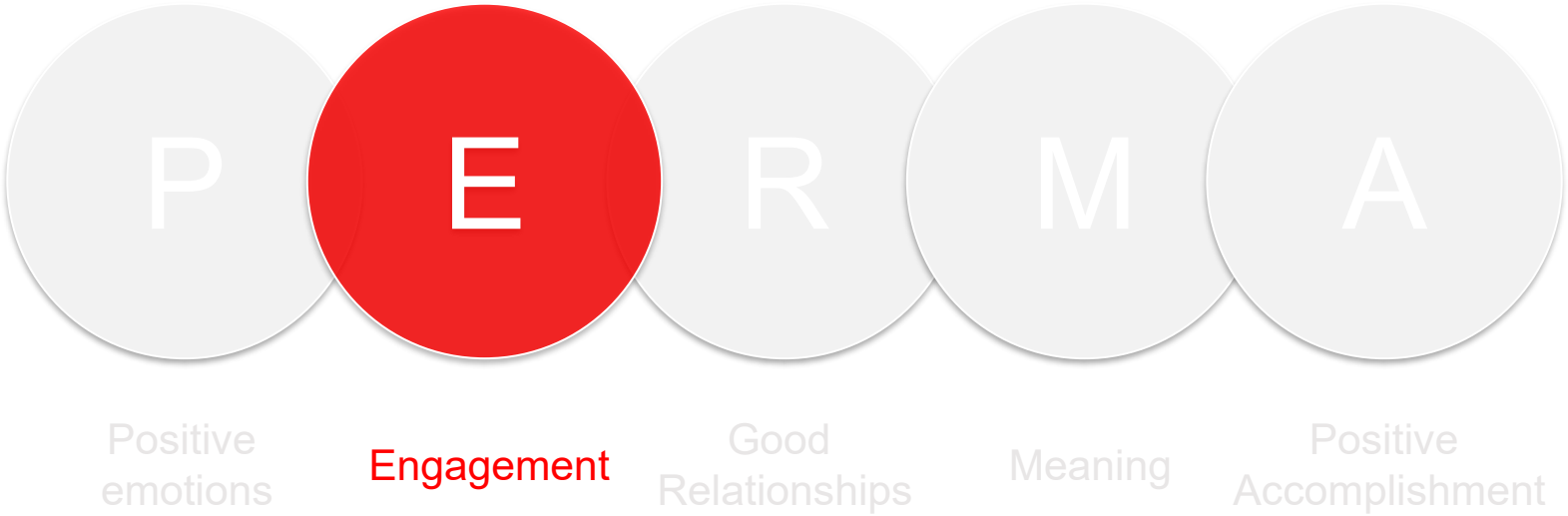
3. Manage your emotions: Metacognition gives you choices

- Choose your reaction to an emotion
- Act the way you want to feel
- Disregard your feelings





PRIVATE **Complete: When I notice ___, I want to pause before I ___**



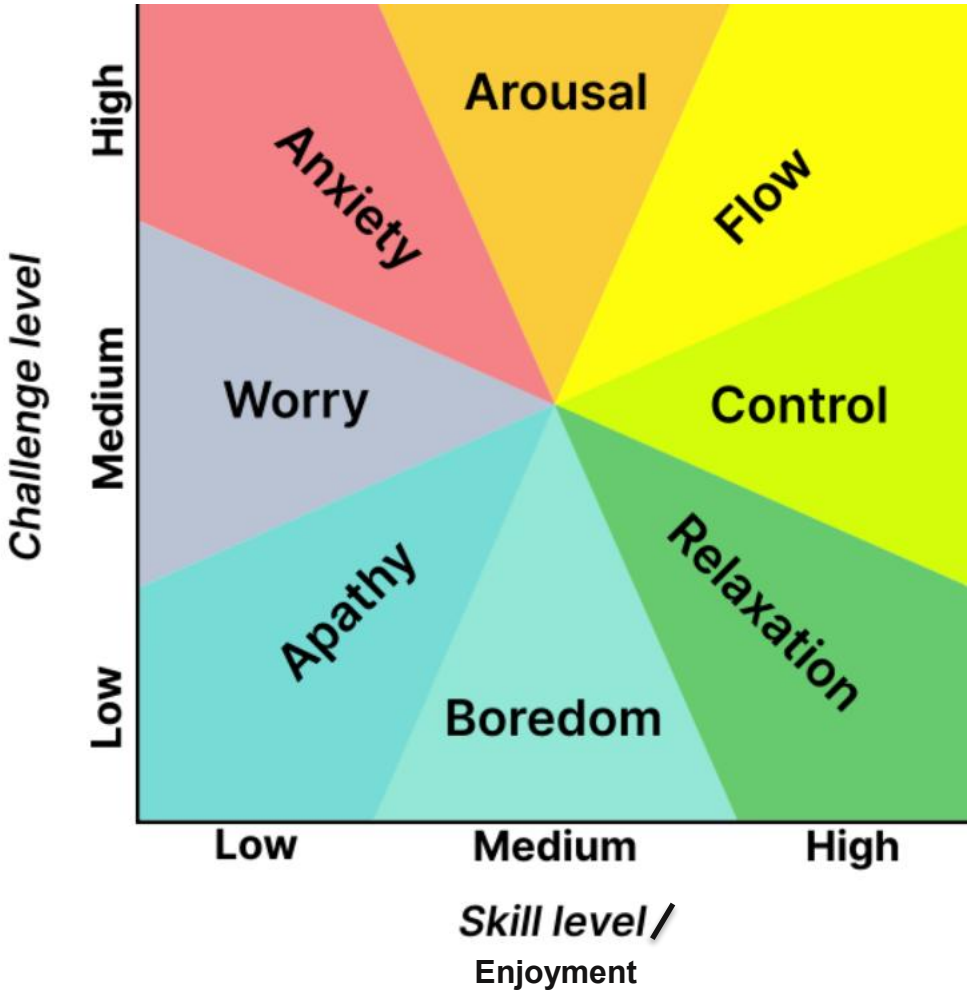
Engaged life

Recall an activity in which you lost track of time

Maslow's (1943) Hierarchy



Cultivate Flow



What can **You** do to achieve flow?

- Set Clear Goals
- Eliminate Distractions
- Seek Challenges
- Clear feedback
- Practice

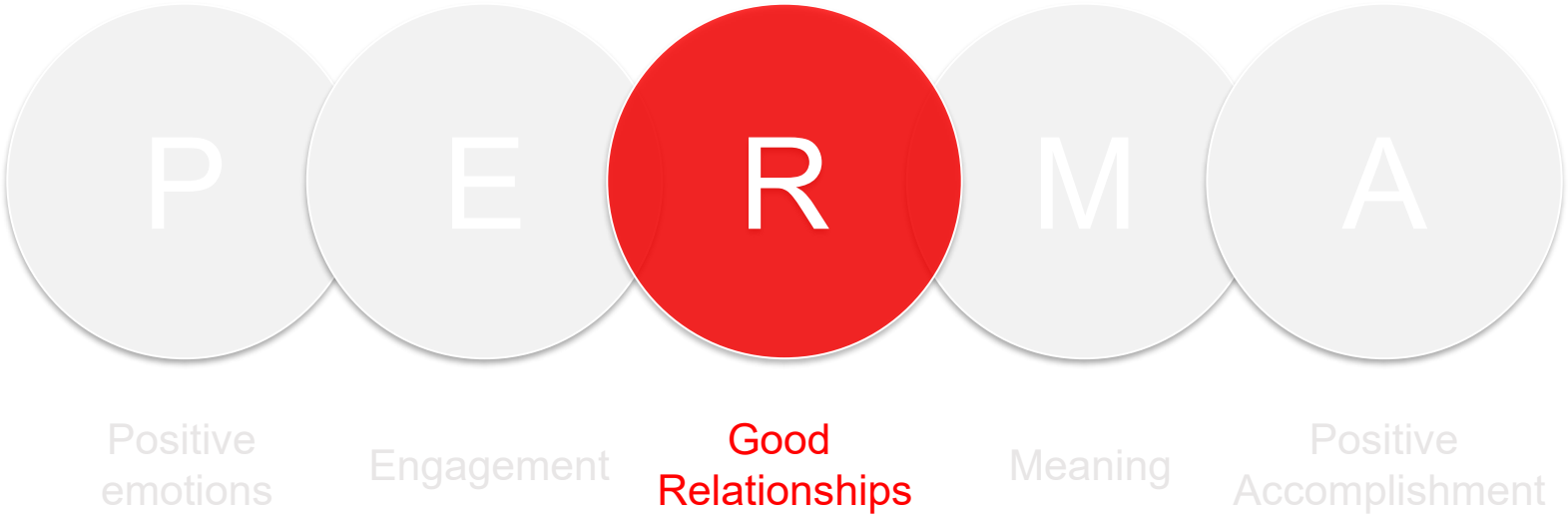
What Can YOU Do?



- **Know Your Strengths:**
  - VIA survey reveals your top character traits
  - Using them boosts meaning in life and work

- **Recraft Around Strengths:**
  - **Recrafting:** Align life with what you naturally do best—at work and beyond
  - **Applications:** Work, Personal Projects, Relationships, Daily Activities, Challenges





Connected life

Cultivate Social Relationships

P E R M A





"Good relationships keep us happier and healthier. Period."

What makes a relationship restorative rather than merely social?

Core Relationships That Drive Well-being & Performance



Family

- Unconditional Love
- Spend time with them



Friends

- You actually choose
- Real ones, no Deal ones



Meaningful work

- Earned Success
- Serve Others



Faith

- Transcendental, bigger than you
- Peace, Perspective (Zoom Out)

Which relationship receives calendar time, and which is left to chance?

Cultivate Social Relationships



- Social capital
- 7 ways to have a connected life:
  1. Spend time with people you like
  2. Both close and superficial - Talking to strangers (Nick Epley)
  3. Share experiences
  4. Losada Ratio: 5-to-1 (John Gottman)
  5. Compassion
  6. Forgiveness
  7. Gratitude: Counterfactuals & diary

Predict your gratitude profile (scale: 1-7)

Careful with social media!

P E R M A

- The Welfare Effects of SM (Allcott et al., 2019)

Sense of Belongingness



Seeking External Approval
Overexposure
Comparisons (Idealized)
Polarization





Meaningful life

What matters to you even when it is not enjoyable?

Two Types of Happiness

P E R M A

- Psychological immune system:
  - **Natural happiness:** what we make when we get what we want
  - **Synthetic happiness:** what we make when we don't get what we want (and it's irreversible)
- Both are equally real
- Source of adaptability, resilience
- Importance of story telling



So What Can We Do?

P E R M A

- Work with purpose creates deeper meaning
- Channel strengths towards bigger causes
- Connecting with beneficiaries = motivation boost (Grant, 2012)
- Many prioritize purpose over money or comfort
  (e.g., Zookeepers, Nurses, Firefighters, Soldiers)



Another Unexpected Ingredient

P E R M A

Suffering

- If you want to be happy, you need unhappiness too
- To be happy, we need meaning. To find meaning, we need suffering (challenge, difficulty)



Remember how lobster grow!

Self-Compassion

P E R M A

- Failures is human
- Face painful thoughts without getting stuck in them
- Treat future self with kindness, not criticism -> Proven to reduce anxiety & boost well-being (Neff et al., 2007)



Think of your last mistake, what would you say to a close friend after the same mistake? What did you say to yourself?

The Power of Your Explanatory Style

P E R M A

- **Optimists** see setbacks as temporary, specific, and external → Resilience
- **Pessimists** view them as permanent, pervasive, and internal → More stress and helplessness
- Your mindset can shape others´ motivation, mood, and your leadership effectiveness (you set the framing)



Predict your learned optimism profile (scale: 1-5)

I got it, at last.
Now what?

We seem to enjoy the process more than the outcome



Achieving life

When does ambition improve well-being, and when does it erode it?

In the Pursuit of Success

P E R M A

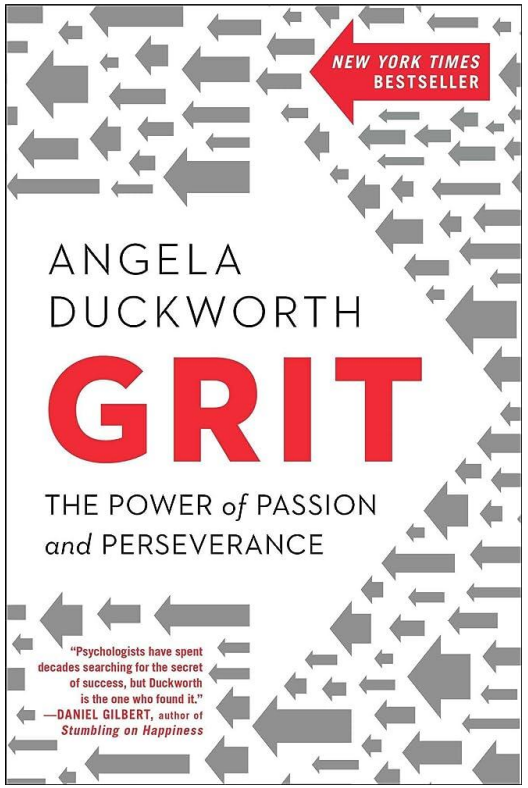
Achievement = Skill x Effort

Skill:

- Speed/Slowness
- Rate of learning
- Talent

Effort:

- Self-discipline
-



Predict your grit profile (scale: 1-5)

Mindsets



Predict your growth/fixed mindset (scale: 1-7)

In the Pursuit of Success



Thank YOU!


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A Mark to Make
A World to Change